Start here for students and parents

You choose one route: Machine Learning or Python for Data Analysis. Both start from the beginning. S.4–S.6 students and vacists are welcome; you do not need coding experience or a particular subject combination.

Before the first class

The camp is held at The National ICT Innovation Hub, Nakawa. Dates and times are confirmed with each group before the first class.

Every learner must have their own laptop and bring its charger, a notebook and a pen. A phone is not sufficient. Arrange a device check before paying. Use a supported computer system and do not install software from links in messages from strangers. The instructor will help with the official tools and check that you can open the first lesson. Tell the instructor about access needs or a device problem early. You do not need a public Google, GitHub or AI account to complete these materials.

Open your student pack

1. Download the ZIP for your chosen track. A ZIP is a compressed folder of files.
2. On Windows, right-click it and choose Extract All. On a Mac, double-click it. Work in the extracted folder, not inside the ZIP viewer.
3. Move the extracted folder to Documents and give it a simple name, such as HolidayCamp. Keep all supplied data files beside your lesson files.
4. Open START_HERE.pdf with a text editor, or ask the instructor for the printed copy. ML01/DA01 is the first lesson; the numbers are the teaching order. Do not attempt the lessons alone in advance. Your track has three core classes a week and no extra labs.
5. Keep a separate folder named MyWork for exported reports and hand-in copies. Run the supplied notebooks beside their CSV files; if you move a notebook into MyWork, copy its data files there too. Use a nickname or organiser-issued learner code in filenames, not a university registration number. Do not put private information into sample datasets.

Python and Jupyter for both tracks

The instructor prepares Python and Jupyter Notebook before class. Python runs instructions; Jupyter displays notebook pages. A file ending .ipynb is a notebook, not a Word document. Open Jupyter from the prepared shortcut or launcher, use its file list to enter your extracted camp folder, and select DA01.ipynb for Data Analysis or ML01.ipynb for Machine Learning. Click a code cell and press Shift+Enter to run it. A text cell explains; a code cell executes. Save with Ctrl+S on Windows or Command+S on Mac. A browser tab showing a local notebook does not mean your file has been submitted online.

If you see text containing braces instead of a notebook page, you opened the file in a text editor; return to Jupyter. If a lesson says a package is missing, ask for the prepared environment instead of pasting unknown installation commands. Never share a notebook-server token or password.

The instructor shows how to restart the kernel (the running Python process) and run all cells from top to bottom. This exposes missing steps hidden in memory. Save a fresh copy before experimenting. The .md

lesson sheet repeats the task in a form you can read without running code.

Your tools

Your tools are Python, NumPy, pandas, matplotlib and seaborn, all in Jupyter Notebook. They are free. The first six classes teach Python from the beginning, pandas starts in class seven, NumPy in class 13 and seaborn in class 14. You do not need Excel, SQL or any account. A CSV is a plain-text table: pandas reads it into a DataFrame (a table object). Keep the supplied CSV files beside your notebooks. Save your code and explanations in .ipynb files, because a CSV holds data and not your code or charts.

Your data comes in two sets. camp_shop.csv is a 60-row practice shop that you can check by hand. The Sunrise Shops files are a larger invented chain of three shops: sunrise_sales.csv, sunrise_products.csv, sunrise_branches.csv, sunrise_daily_summary.csv, sunrise_products_practice.csv and the messy sunrise_sales_raw.csv. The data is invented, so it says nothing about real shops.

Your final hand-in includes project.ipynb, cleaning_log.md, a data dictionary, report.pdf or report.docx and AI_USE_LOG.md. Keep the supplied source CSV with the project for rerunning. Your notebook contains charts and findings. No interactive dashboard or Excel workbook is required. Save five presentation slides as showcase.pptx for the final demonstration.

How each class works

Every class follows the same steps. Read the words for today. Predict what a small example will do and write your guess on paper. Run it and compare. Investigate by answering two or three questions about the output. Modify one value and explain the new result. Then do the independent Make task and save it. Each sheet ends with an error card for the two errors most likely that day and an exit ticket sentence. Ask whenever a word, symbol or instruction is unclear. The instructor checks each learner's work in the small group.

Use two 45 to 60 minute practice blocks on non-class days as a starting routine. Take breaks. If stuck for 30 minutes, save the error and the question for class instead of copying an answer you cannot explain. Practice is expected; it is how the skills become usable.

How to submit assessed work

The organiser will issue a private submission route and the actual dates. These materials do not contain a live school upload form. Use only the route named for this camp, not an IUEA university assignment form.

1. Read the lesson's required filenames and formats. For an individual project, include the complete requested set.
2. Save, close and reopen each file. Check that code runs, Python notebooks rerun and report text can be selected.
3. In Word use Save As for DOCX or Export for PDF. In LibreOffice Writer use Save As for DOCX or Export as PDF. For presentations use PowerPoint or Impress and save PPTX. Keep editable originals. Do not substitute photos of pages for an editable or text-readable file.
4. Open the issued collection link or folder, sign in only if the organiser's chosen route requires it, and upload the files. If a form is used, finish its Submit step. Keep the confirmation.

5. Keep a local copy. If uploading fails, preserve your files and contact the organiser through the agreed channel. Saving locally is not the same as submission.

Projects and certificates

You will demonstrate your own project to parents and guardians in the final week. You can share a local/private copy; public posting is optional and requires appropriate agreement. Completion certificates depend on the published attendance, assessment, project and demonstration requirements. These are programme certificates, not university qualifications or certificates from Google, IBM or another course provider.

Make your first short presentation

Open PowerPoint or LibreOffice Impress and choose a blank presentation. A slide is one screen of information. Click the title box and type your project question. Add a new slide using Home > New Slide in PowerPoint or Slide > New Slide in Impress. Use a title and content layout for one main idea at a time. Insert your saved chart or screenshot using Insert > Pictures/Image; do not stretch it so labels become distorted. Use the Notes area below the slide to write what you will say, rather than placing your whole speech on the slide.

Create the five slides specified in your lesson. Save as PPTX, close it and reopen it. Start the slide show from the beginning and practise with a five-minute timer. Keep a PDF or screenshots as a backup. Check that no names, contact details or private marks appear in a demonstration image. Menu names may differ slightly across versions; ask the instructor to show the installed version before starting.

Responsible AI literacy

Read AI_USE_POLICY.pdf. Weeks 1–6: no AI-generated solutions for core exercises, labs or assessments. Weeks 7–8: demonstration, critique and limited supervised use only after independent foundations; keep AI_USE_LOG.md for any permitted assistance. Students must understand, test and explain all work. Final demonstrations and assessment explanations are completed without AI assistance. Core exercises remain unaided throughout. Session 21 uses AI_CODING_ASSISTANTS_LAB.pdf within the existing practice time.